

Acme Business Travel Policy

Department: Finance and Admin. Version 2025. Effective 1 April 2025.

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy explains how employees book, approve and claim for business travel. It applies to all grades, L1 to L5, for travel inside India and abroad. Travel that is paid for by a client is outside this policy unless the client contract says otherwise. The money limits that depend on grade, such as the hotel limit per night and the daily meal allowance, are kept in the Expense Limits workbook and not repeated here.

2. Booking Flights and Trains

All tickets must be booked through the company travel desk in the Admin portal. Tickets booked directly by the employee are reimbursed only if the travel desk could not offer the same journey, and a screenshot of the desk's reply must be attached to the claim. Book at least 7 days before the travel date, because fares rise sharply close to departure.

Trains are the default choice for journeys under 6 hours, for example Ahmedabad to Mumbai. Air travel is allowed for longer journeys or when a train is not available on the required day. The class of travel depends on grade and is listed in the Expense Limits workbook. Business class is only available to L5, or to anyone on a flight longer than 6 hours when the department head has approved it in advance.

3. Pre-Approval of Trips

Every trip needs the reporting manager's approval in the Admin portal before booking. A trip needs the additional approval of the department head if it is longer than 3 nights or if the estimated cost is more than 25,000 INR. Pre-approval requests for these trips must be raised at least 5 working days before departure.

International travel always needs the approval of the department head and the finance controller, whatever the cost. The traveller must also carry a valid passport and visa and register the trip with the Admin desk so that travel insurance can be arranged. Approval is not needed again for a change of dates, but a change of destination needs a new request.

4. Hotels and Local Travel

Hotels must be booked through the travel desk. The maximum rate per night depends on grade and is listed in the Expense Limits workbook. A stay above the limit needs the department head's approval before booking, and the extra amount is otherwise recovered from the employee. In cities where a company guest house is available, employees are expected to use it instead of a hotel.

For local travel, employees can claim metro, bus, auto-rickshaw and app-cab fares up to the daily local travel limit for their grade. Car rental for a whole day needs the manager's approval. Personal vehicle use is reimbursed at 9 INR per kilometre for a car and 4 INR per kilometre for a two-wheeler, with a trip log attached.

5. Claiming Travel Expenses

A travel claim must be submitted in the Finance portal within 10 working days of returning from the trip. Claims submitted later are paid only with the approval of the finance controller. Every claim needs the original ticket or boarding pass, the hotel invoice, and receipts for any single expense above 500 INR. Meals are paid as a fixed daily allowance and need no receipts.

Advance payments are available for trips longer than 3 nights. The advance can be up to 70 percent of the estimated cost and must be settled within 10 working days of the trip. An unsettled advance is deducted from the next month's salary.

6. Non-Reimbursable Items

The company does not reimburse minibar and alcohol charges, laundry for trips shorter than 5 nights, personal entertainment, traffic fines, or the cost of upgrading a ticket or room above the entitlement of the employee's grade, unless the upgrade was approved in advance.

7. Exceptions

Exceptions to this policy can be approved by the finance controller in writing. The employee should explain why the policy could not be followed and attach any supporting email. An exception approved once does not set a precedent for later trips.